

Farming Research Units in Maharashtra

1. Vasantrao Naik Marathwada Krishi Vidyapeeth (VNMKV), Parbhani

VNMKV is a premier agricultural university in Maharashtra, established in 1972 and located in Parbhani. It plays a critical role in promoting education, research, and extension activities in the Marathwada region. The university has several regional research stations and Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs) under its jurisdiction.

VNMKV focuses on crop improvement, soil health management, and sustainable agricultural practices. It actively works on pulses, cereals, and oilseeds, and collaborates in all-India coordinated projects. It publishes numerous research papers, technical bulletins, and advisories in both Marathi and English, enabling efficient knowledge transfer to farmers and researchers.

For your project, these documents serve as ideal candidates for multilingual indexing and retrieval. By feeding these into a RAG-based LLM system, farmers can query about crop advisories or pest management practices in Marathi and receive contextually accurate responses, increasing accessibility and impact.

2. Dr. Panjabrao Deshmukh Krishi Vidyapeeth (PDKV), Akola

PDKV is a leading agricultural university located in Akola, serving the Vidarbha region. It was established in 1969 and has 20 research stations working on various crops including cotton, soybean, sorghum, and pulses. PDKV has developed many important crop varieties such as PKV-2 (cotton), TAG-24 (groundnut), and several black-gram lines.

The university supports extensive research in horticulture, entomology, pathology, and farm machinery. It provides crop-specific and region-specific documentation, often in English and Marathi. These resources include crop production guides, pest and disease management charts, and weather-based farming advisories.

Integrating these documents into your smart multilingual chatbot can assist in answering user questions like What is the best time to sow black gram in Akola? in local languages with precise responses grounded in research data.

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3. Dr. Balasaheb Sawant Konkan Krishi Vidyapeeth (DBSKKV), Dapoli

DBSKKV, located in Dapoli, focuses on agriculture in the coastal Konkan region of Maharashtra. Since its inception in 1972, it has specialized in rice, horticulture (especially mango and cashew), and fisheries. The university has 15 off-campus research stations and multiple Krishi Vigyan Kendras.

It has developed notable rice varieties like Karjat-3 and provides in-depth documentation on water management, coastal soil fertility, and integrated pest management. These resources are bilingual and tailored to the region's farmers, making them highly valuable for multilingual AI-driven knowledge systems.

For your chatbot, these documents can help answer natural language queries in Marathi like `?` with well-sourced, understandable replies. This bridges the digital divide in rural coastal Maharashtra.

4. ICAR Central Citrus Research Institute (CCRI), Nagpur

CCRI is an ICAR institute located in Nagpur, focusing exclusively on citrus research. It deals with crop improvement, nutrient management, disease control, and post-harvest processing of citrus fruits, especially Nagpur orange. CCRI is a hub for citrus growers in Maharashtra and beyond.

The institute publishes research findings, disease calendars, fertilizer schedules, and best practices guides in English and regional languages. These documents can form the basis for a focused RAG pipeline where citrus growers can ask questions about fruit rot, nutrient deficiencies, or export procedures in their native tongue.

For your project, CCRI documents will provide domain-specific, structured agricultural information, suitable for both AI model training and deployment as a smart query-answering assistant in citrus farming areas.

5. Nimbkar Agricultural Research Institute (NARI), Phaltan

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NARI is a private non-profit R&D institute located in Phaltan, Satara district. Established in 1968, it focuses on dryland agriculture, renewable energy, and animal husbandry. NARI has developed safflower hybrids with high oil content, energy-efficient ethanol technologies, and multi-purpose livestock breeds.

Its documentation includes technical manuals, field trial data, and implementation guides in English and Marathi. Their innovations in sustainable farming, bioenergy, and water conservation are ideal data points for your chatbot to support queries from NGOs, rural entrepreneurs, or farmers seeking innovative practices.

Using NARI documents, your RAG-LLM system can guide users asking for innovative dryland crops or renewable energy options for farms with intelligent, localized suggestions supported by years of real-world research.